Welcome to research life in the US!

Each of you will be delivering a research presentation to the team. It'll be Thursday afternoon for Cedric and Friday afternoon for Noe. You should rehearse this presentation (e.g., present to each other first) and ensure that it lasts between 25 to 30 minutes. Slides should be numbered, so that we may ask questions on specific slides. Keep distractions minimal in your visuals (e.g., black text on white background is ok, animations can only be used if they contribute to communicating your message). Use the presentation template provided on the Google Drive. Please insert 'question breaks' so that the audience can ask you questions at several points during the presentation, rather than only at the end.

Your presentation should cover the following:

- **What is your research question?**
- **Why does it matter?** A question isn't useful just because nobody else has the answer. "What should I eat for breakfast" is a question too… A *research* question needs to be well-motivated, so that we can convince people that our answer is worth publishing. Think of the implications of your research (what does it mean if your project is a success? Who benefits, how?) and the current state of the field (is it a major improvement over what people already have? A small step?).
- **How will you proceed?** This should take most of your presentation and it is the most important point to get feedback from the group. Start with an overview slide: what are the main steps? What would you obtain at the end of each step, and how does it go into the next step? Try to be as specific as possible, while we understand that you are *proposing* some steps and we don't know yet whether it will work. Explain why you are conducting these steps: how do you know that it's the right course of action? Is there a plan B, or alternatives that you have considered?
  If parts of your method involve natural language prompts (e.g., to GPT, Claude, Llama3, or Gemini), then you should have tested them a little bit prior to the presentation so you already know if it works. ChatGPT is fine for quick testing of a prompt idea. If you want to test ideas more thoroughly, you should use the API via a Jupyter Notebook.
- **How will you know if it worked?** Whenever you develop a system/product, you need to measure its quality. That would provide evidence that it is fit-for-purpose. So you need to be clear about what you will measure, and have some expectations about what results would be sufficient.

As a reminder, here are the questions that you are pursuing:
[For Noe] How to transform simulation outcomes into clear, unbiased explanations that support decision-making activities among non-experts?
[For Cedric] How to combine causal maps covering different parts of a system?[1]

To help you prepare your presentation, selected readings have been uploaded on the google drive. It would be inefficient to print them and highlight. You are encouraged to annotate them as PDFs (via Acrobat).

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[1] *The description given by email was:* Chaque personne a un modele, qu'elle peut externaliser sous forme d'une carte (noeuds avec des noms, arcs avec des types + ou -). En general, on demande a plusieurs personnes de creer leurs modeles, puis on les combine pour avoir une vue d'ensemble. La combinaison (aussi appelle aggregation) est censee etre une operation mathematiquement close/fermee : les noeuds dans la carte du groupe forment l'union des noeuds dans les cartes des individus. Ca semble logique au debut : une personne dit que A -> B -> C, une autre dit que D -> B et B -> A, on met tout ca ensemble et c'est regle. Mais il arrive que des individus parlent de differentes parties d'un systeme ; par exemple, personne 1 dit que A -> B et personne 2 dit que X -> Y. Pour les mettre ensemble, il est necessaire de creer des aretes, et probablement des noeuds. C'est la que le LLM interview : un LLM est un modele de connaissances (apprises sur des tas de donnees) et on peut l'utiliser pour completer des connaissances existantes. Autrement dit, on pourrait (la est la question) **utiliser un LLM pour connecter des points de vue** sur des sujets qui sont censes etre lies. En entree on a un ensemble de cartes individuelles {G1, ..., Gn} avec tres peu (voire rien) en commun. En sortie on a une seule carte G, connexe.